

1. Title Page

Title: A concise and descriptive title reflecting the main focus of the research.

Author's Name: Full name(s) of the author(s).

Institutional Affiliation: The university, organization, or institution where the research was conducted.

Date: The date of submission or publication.

2. Abstract

A brief summary of the research paper (usually 150–250 words).

Includes:

The research problem or objective.

Methods used.

Key findings.

Conclusion or implications.

Written in a single paragraph without citations.

3. Introduction

Background: Provides context for the research problem.

Research Problem: Clearly states the issue or question being addressed.

Objectives: Outlines the goals of the study.

Significance: Explains why the research is important.

Thesis Statement: The main argument or hypothesis.

4. Literature Review

Summarizes and analyzes existing research related to the topic.

Identifies gaps in the literature that the current study aims to address.

Organizes sources thematically or chronologically.

Properly cites all references.

5. Methodology

Describes how the research was conducted.

Includes:

Research Design: Qualitative, quantitative, or mixed methods.

Participants: Sample size, demographics, and selection criteria.

Data Collection: Tools and procedures (e.g., surveys, experiments, interviews).

Data Analysis: Techniques used to analyze the data (e.g., statistical tests, thematic analysis).

Written in past tense and in sufficient detail for replication.

6. Results

Presents the findings of the study.

Uses text, tables, and figures to display data.

Does not include interpretation or discussion (save this for the Discussion section).

Clearly labels all visuals (e.g., tables, charts, graphs) and refers to them in the text.

7. Discussion

Interprets the results and explains their significance.

Relates findings to the research question and objectives.

Compares results with previous studies.

Discusses limitations of the study.

Suggests implications for future research or practical applications.

8. Conclusion

Summarizes the key findings and their importance.

Restates the thesis or research question.

Provides a final thought or call to action (if applicable).

9. References

Lists all sources cited in the paper.

Follows a specific citation style (e.g., APA, MLA, Chicago).

Alphabetized by the author's last name.

10. Appendices (if applicable)

Includes supplementary materials such as:

Raw data.

Interview transcripts.

Additional tables or figures.

Research instruments (e.g., questionnaires).

Example Outline of a Research Paper

Title: The Impact of Social Media on Mental Health Among Teenagers

Abstract:

This study examines the relationship between social media usage and mental health outcomes among adolescents aged 13–18. A survey of 200 participants revealed a significant correlation between excessive social media use and increased anxiety levels. The findings suggest the need for interventions to promote balanced social media usage.

Introduction:

Social media has become an integral part of teenagers' lives, but its impact on mental health remains controversial. This study aims to explore the correlation between social media usage and anxiety levels among adolescents.

Literature Review:

Previous studies have shown mixed results, with some highlighting the benefits of social media for social connection and others emphasizing its negative effects on mental health (Smith et al., 2020; Johnson, 2019).

Methodology:

A quantitative survey was conducted with 200 teenagers aged 13–18. Data were collected using a validated anxiety scale and analyzed using SPSS.

Results:

Teenagers who spent more than three hours per day on social media reported significantly higher anxiety levels ($p < 0.05$).

Discussion:

The findings align with previous research suggesting a link between excessive social media use and poor mental health outcomes. Limitations include the reliance on self-reported data.

Conclusion:

This study highlights the need for further research and interventions to address the mental health risks associated with social media use among teenagers.

References:

Smith, J., et al. (2020). Social media and mental health. *Journal of Adolescent Health*, 45(3), 123–130.
Johnson, L. (2019). The dark side of social media. *Psychological Review*, 12(2), 45–60.

Appendices:

Appendix A: Survey Questionnaire

Appendix B: Raw Data